telecommunication infrastructure have made a promising beginning in India, the country has enormous ground to cover in the digital technology and infrastructure sweepstakes. The ability to create artificial intelligence and harness it for production and distribution of goods and services, including newer digital goods and services, will make a critical difference going forward.

Third, the code is the heart of digital transformation. It makes everything digital—chips, technology, cloud, platforms, applications—work. India has created excellent companies and there are many start-ups that are leading development of codes—the software. Indian companies and start-ups are also catching up with the development of SaaS and software-defined infrastructure (SDI), though our share of the global software market is still minuscule, at less than 2 per cent. Like one-third share India could command in information technology services, India can legitimately aim at garnering one-third share in global software writing and deployment.

Fourth, digitalization of services was massively encouraged by the development of data transfer networks. India was in the forefront of this segment of digital economy capitalizing on its quality labour processing the raw data into usable data/information. The country still commands a very large share of global IT services. IT services comprise over 60 per cent of India's export of services. There are two major challenges emerging in this area: other processing destinations have come up and data generation and use is becoming transactional. Both these challenges are likely to cause the IT market to slowly taper off in future. India would need to train and prepare its youth and manpower as global digital workers.

India's digital policy framework must address all the four imperatives.

India's Best Bet Lies in Software and Digital Services

Development of software for digitalization of existing businesses, creating and running digital platforms, applications, networks and machines using